

Sakina Ghafoor

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EDUCATION

Texas Christian University College of Science & Engineering Experimental Psychology PhD	In Progress Fort Worth, Texas
Texas Christian University College of Science & Engineering Experimental Psychology MS	In Progress Fort Worth, Texas
Texas Christian University College of Science & Engineering Psychology BS, Data Science Minor	Fort Worth, Texas

EXPERIENCE

Texas Christian University Institute of Behavioral Research, Graduate Research Assistant Student Overview of Applied Research (SOAR) Lab, Student Mentor	May 2025 - Present
Texas Christian University Institute of Behavioral Research, Undergraduate Research Assistant and Referral Coordinator Undergraduate Advanced Internship, Tier 3 - Increasing Access to PrEP for Minority Women by Leveraging Beauty Shops as Community Health Hubs and Mobile Healthcare - Coordinated referrals, developed guides for community resources, and managed REDCap database management system to collect data and clinical information.	Aug 2024 - Apr 2025
JPMorgan Chase Technology Audit, Summer Analyst Intern - EPiX (Engineer Platform & Experience) Team - Focusing on reviews of business applications, data management, global infrastructure, digital technologies, and cyber/information security. Evaluating the effectiveness of controls for the EPiX (Engineer Platform & Experience) team looking at technology development. Providing management with feedback regarding the control environment.	Jun 2024 - Aug 2024
Texas Christian University Institute of Behavioral Research, Undergraduate Research Assistant Undergraduate Apprenticeship, Tier 2 - Increasing Access to PrEP for Minority Women by Leveraging Beauty Shops as Community Health Hubs and Mobile Healthcare - Collaborated with research staff to assist with data-collection protocols for Mobile Health Unit health services including cancer screenings, access to contraceptives/PrEP, mental health, social support, and STI testing. Built out the study data collection tool and electronic-medical record system for use on the mobile clinic and in the field using the REDCap database management system	Jun 2023 - May 2024

- Worked with a startup team in a scientific study on the effects of a novel AI planning software on education outcomes and contributed to a well-structured report that helps inform future decisions. Helped recruit volunteers from a sample of college students and collected high-quality, relevant data. Insightfully analyzed data and contributed to research findings.

PUBLICATIONS

Villaire, S., Hastings, S., Johnson, M., Reid, Q., **Ghafoor, S.**, Carey, P. D., Proffitt, R. P., & Knight, K. (2026). Bridging beauty and wellness: Examining beauty professionals' comfort in discussing sexual health. *Frontiers in Reproductive Health*, 7, Article 1688125. <https://doi.org/10.3389/frph.2025.1688125>

Sease, T. B., Weise, A. L., **Ghafoor, S.**, & Knight, K. (under review). *Development and Preliminary Testing of a Criminal Thinking Measure for the General Population*.

PRESENTATIONS

Ha, J., Ibe, C., Johnson, L., Rishel, K., Borne, B., Estes, B., Farah, V., Miguel, K., Ocampo, G., Reyes, S., Soto, I., Olabisi, E., **Ghafoor, S.**, Sease, A., & Knight, K. (2026, April). *Amen and Awareness: A Fort Worth Faith Community Study on HIV Prevention*. Poster Presentation at the TCU Louise Dilworth Davis CSE 23rd Annual Student Research Symposium, Fort Worth, Texas.

Ghafoor, S., Castillo, R., Sease, T., & Knight, K. (2026, March). *A Machine Learning Approach to Patient Perceptions of AI in Clinical Encounters*. Poster Presentation at the Southwestern Psychological Association 2026 Annual Conference, Frisco, Texas.

Ghafoor, S., Castillo, R., Sease, T., & Knight, K. (2025, October). *Hostility as a Prospective Mediator of the Relationship Between Treatment Engagement and Decision Making for People in Court-Mandated Substance Use Treatment*. Poster Presentation at the Southwestern Association of Criminal Justice 2025 Annual Conference, Fort Worth, Texas.

Castillo, R., **Ghafoor, S.**, Sease, T., & Knight, K. (2025, October). *Leveraging AI to Uncover Strengths: A Qualitative Study on Reintegration Success for Justice-Involved Individuals*. Poster Presentation at the Southwestern Association of Criminal Justice 2025 Annual Conference, Fort Worth, Texas.

Villaire, S., Reid, Q., **Ghafoor, S.**, Hastings, S., Carey, P., Proffitt, R., & Knight, K. (2025, April). *Increasing PrEP Access for Black Women: The Role of Beauty Professionals in HIV Prevention Education*. Poster Presentation at the Texas Christian University Student Research Symposium, Fort Worth, Texas.

Ghafoor, S., DeMattia, M., Wrucke, M., Blakeney, B., Reimer, C., Sease, T. B., Wiese, A. L., & Knight, K. (2024, April). *Testing the Feasibility and Engagement of a Brief Mindfulness Intervention for Nursing Students*. Poster Presentation at the Texas Christian University Student Research Symposium, Fort Worth, Texas.

Sease, T. B., **Ghafoor, S.**, & Cox, C. (2024, February). *State of Surrender: A Novel & Distinct Correlate of Psychological Well-Being*. Poster accepted to the Society for Personality and Social Psychology Conference, San Diego CA.

Ghafoor, S., Rippey, L., Bliss, L., Gomez, J., Sease, T. B., Wiese, A. L., & Knight, K. (2023, April). *Developing a Measure of Criminal Thinking for the General Population*. Poster Presentation at the Texas Christian University Student Research Symposium, Fort Worth, Texas.

Ghafoor, S., Rippey, L., Bliss, L., Gomez, J., Sease, T. B., Wiese, A. L., & Knight, K. (2023, April). *Developing a Measure of Criminal Thinking for the General Population*. Poster Presentation at the Texas Christian University, Impact of Health and Justice Research on Policy and Practice Conference for the 60th Anniversary of the Institute of Behavioral Research, Fort Worth, Texas.

SKILLS & CERTIFICATIONS

Tools & Technologies	
Java, JavaScript, Python, Linux, C, Scala, C Language Integrated Production System (CLIPS), R, Microsoft Office, SPSS, Google Colab/Jupyter, Jamovi, Qualtrics, PowerBI, ATLAS.ti, REDCap	
TCU Responsible Conduct in Research Compliance Training	Aug 2025
CITI Information Privacy Security: Health Privacy (HIPAA)	Jul 2025
Forage Internal Audit Analyst Virtual Experience Program	Aug 2023
freeCodeCamp Machine Learning with Python	Aug 2023
freeCodeCamp Data Analysis with Python	Jul 2023
HackerRank Java (Basic)	Jul 2023
CITI Initial Biosafety Training	Jun 2023
CITI OSHA Bloodborne Pathogens	Jun 2023
CITI Conflict of Interest	Oct 2022
CITI Human Subjects Research	Oct 2022

REFERENCES

Randi P. Proffitt, Ph.D.
Research Scientist, Institute of Behavioral Research (IBR), Texas Christian University
Associate Graduate Faculty, College of Science & Engineering, Texas Christian University
Assistant Professor of Medical Education, TCU Burnett School of Medicine

Thomas Sease, Ph.D.
Research Scientist, Institute of Behavioral Research (IBR), Texas Christian University

Pamela Carey, D.P.A.
Research Scientist, Institute of Behavioral Research (IBR), Texas Christian University
